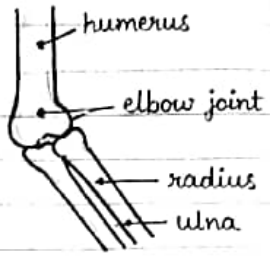
Joints and Its Types :

1. **What is a joint ?**

Ans: A joint is the place where two or more bones meet or come together.

Example : The elbow joint is formed where the upper arm bone and forearm bones meet.



2. **Functions of joints :-**

Joints help our body to :-

1. Join bones together.
2. Provide movement to different parts of the body.
3. Give flexibility to the skeleton.
4. Provide support and stability to the body.

3. **Types of joints :-**

Joints are mainly classified into three types :-

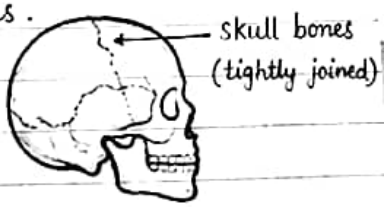
1. Immovable joints
2. Slightly movable joints
3. Freely movable joints

1. **Immovable joints :-**

These joints do not allow movement between the bones.

Example : Joints between the bones of the skull.

The bones of the skull are tightly joined together to protect the brain.

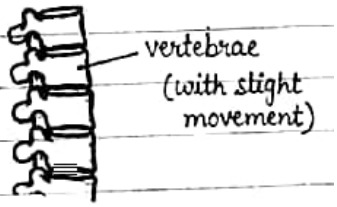


2. **Slightly movable joints :-**

These joints allow only limited or slight movement.

Example : Joints between the vertebrae of the backbone.

They provide some flexibility while also supporting the backbone.



3. **Freely movable joints :**

These joints allow free movement of bones.

They are also called synovial joints.

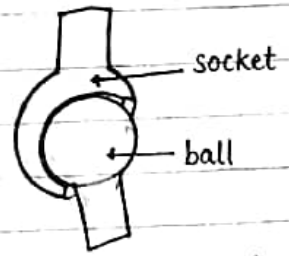
They are further divided into :

A. **Ball and socket joint :**

In this joint, the rounded end of one bone fits into a cup-like socket of another bone.

It allows movement in many directions, including rotation.

Example : Shoulder joint, Hip joint.



(Shoulder joint)

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A. Ball and socket joint : (concl.)

B. Hinge Joint :

These joints allow movement mainly in one direction, like the hinge of a door.

Example : Elbow joint, Knee joint, Fingers.



Elbow joint



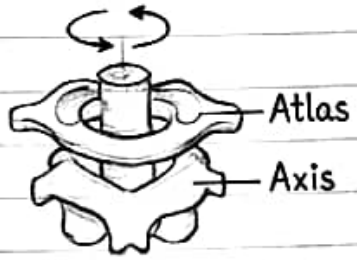
with the 'hinge' movement

C. Pivot Joint :

These joints allow one bone to rotate around another bone.

Example : Joint between the first and second vertebrae of the neck (Atlas and Axis).

It helps us to turn our head from side to side.



Neck pivot joint

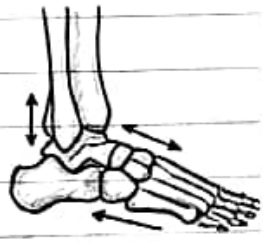
D. Gliding Joint :

These joints allow bones to slide or glide over one another.

Example : Joints between the bones of the wrist and ankle.



Wrist joints



Ankle joints

Type of Joint	Movement	Example
Immovable	No movement	Skull
Slightly movable	Limited movement	Vertebrae
Ball and socket	Movement in many directions including rotation	Shoulder, Hip
Hinge	Back and forth	Elbow, Knee
Pivot	Rotation	Neck
Gliding	Sliding	Wrist, Ankle

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